

YUFEI ZHANG

+86 159 9625 1109 | 15996251109@163.com | [emily-cheung-1902.github.io](https://github.com/emily-cheung-1902)

Last updated: August 5, 2026

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Mental health, social inequality, and life-course transitions in later life; narratives and representations of aging; computational social science.

EDUCATION

Nanjing University	Nanjing, China
M.A. in Journalism and Communication (Computational Communication)	2024–2027
GPA: 4.00/4.00	
Communication University of China	Beijing, China
B.Eng. in Cyberspace Security; Minor in Computational Communication	2020–2024
GPA: 3.64/4.00	

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES AND REGISTERED REPORTS

[1] Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z. (2025). Depression trajectories from mid to late life (50–89 years): The roles of cohort, multimorbidity status, and national contexts across nine European countries. *Social Science & Medicine*, 385, 118605. doi:10.1016/j.socscimed.2025.118605

[2] Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z. (2026). Depressive symptom trajectories around the retirement transition across countries and historical periods [Stage 2 Registered Report]. *PsyArXiv*. doi:10.31234/osf.io/6ypwr_v6 Peer-reviewed and recommended by Peer Community in Registered Reports (PCI RR).

SELECTED PREPRINTS AND MANUSCRIPTS

[1] Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z. (2026). Psychometric comparability of LLM-based digital twins. *SSRN*. doi:10.2139/ssrn.5967255 Revise and resubmit at *Nature Communications*.

[2] Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z. (2026). Loneliness from midlife to older adulthood reflects both stable trait and changing circumstance. *PsyArXiv*. doi:10.31234/osf.io/7fc9v_v1 Under review.

[3] Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z. (2026). Digital exclusion among middle-aged and older adults in China: Age–period–cohort evidence from three national surveys, 2011–2022. *PsyArXiv*. doi:10.31234/osf.io/hpv68_v1 Under review.

[4] Yang, Y., Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z. (2026). Quality of life in middle and later life across Europe: Trait–occasion decomposition using the measurement-aligned SHARE CASP-12. *PsyArXiv*. doi:10.31234/osf.io/hwaks_v1 Under review.

[5] Yang, Y., Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z. (2026). Early identification of adolescent mental health risk through integrated game-based assessment and large language model psychological inference. Under review at *The British Journal of Social Work*.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Computational Communication Collaboratory, Nanjing University	Nanjing, China
Graduate Researcher Supervisor: Zhihao Ma	2024–Present
Psychological Adaptation and Social Participation from Midlife to Later Life	Sep. 2024–Present
- Examine how age, cohort, retirement transitions, and national contexts shape depression, loneliness, and social participation using large-scale longitudinal and cross-national survey data. - Investigate digital exclusion and socioeconomic and health inequalities using age–period–cohort, multilevel, latent-variable, and longitudinal models.	
Digital Twin Psychometrics	Aug. 2025–Present
- Evaluate the psychometric comparability of LLM-based digital twins and human respondents across psychological, behavioral, and open-ended text tasks. - Design multi-study evaluations across models and prompting conditions to assess construct validity and human–LLM alignment using psychometric, network, calibration, and text-analytic methods.	
Constructing Old Age: A Cross-National Diachronic Analysis of Aging Narratives	Oct. 2025–Present
- Analyze cross-national and historical changes in narratives of aging using large-scale diachronic corpora and word embeddings. - Examine age stereotypes and social representations through semantic association, time-series, and multilevel analyses.	

TEACHING AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Nanjing University	
Computational Communication Research Training Program (Graduate Course)	Fall 2026

Causal Inference (Graduate Course)	Spring 2026
Applications of LLMs in Digital Humanities (Undergraduate Course)	Spring 2026
Social Research Methods (Undergraduate Course)	Fall 2025, Fall 2026
Academic Writing and Social Research Methods (Undergraduate Course)	Spring 2025
Reporting Intern, Hong Kong, Macao, and Taiwan Desk, Xinhua News Agency	May–Aug. 2023

RESEARCH GRANT

Determinants of Digital Exclusion Among Middle-Aged and Older Adults	Nov. 2025
Distinguished Talent Cultivation Program (2025GYB18) Principal Investigator RMB 6,000	

SELECTED HONORS AND AWARDS

Excellent Graduate Student, Nanjing University	Dec. 2025
National Scholarship for Graduate Students	Nov. 2025
First-Class Academic Scholarship	Nov. 2025
Second-Class Academic Scholarship	Dec. 2024

METHODS

Longitudinal and multilevel modeling; age–period–cohort analysis; latent-variable modeling; natural language processing; psychometric and semantic network analysis.	
--	--